



Risk Mitigation Case Brief

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Case A: Microsoft

Vulnerability: Cloud resources also proactive

The shift to cloud services and remote work removed the traditional security perimeter. Employees were accessing the resources from everywhere, which increased the risk of unauthorized access.

Ways to fix this : zero trust required verification for every access requests, MFA blocks attackers even if passwords leak, and regular audits keep defenses updated. Together these measures directly reduce unauthorized access and strengthen ID security. It also is proactive because Microsoft changed its entire security model before a major breach forced them to. Zero trust is built on assuming breaches and trying to prevent it. Another strategy they could use if Microsoft chose risk avoidance, they would have avoided cloud expansion and remote work features. This severely limited their business growth and made them less competitive. If they chose risk acceptance , they would have faced constant breaches and huge financial and reputational damages.

Case B: Google

Vulnerability: lots of data also proactive

Google's massive user base and global services made them a primary target for attackers, vulnerabilities in any widely used software could impact millions or billions of users.

Bug bounty programs uncover vulnerabilities early , internal review such as catching weaknesses before attackers do , and responsible disclosure forces vendors to make patches immediately.

Google's approach is proactive because project zero hunts for vulnerabilities before attackers exploit them. They don't wait for breaches, they are actively always searching for weaknesses.

Alternative strategy would be risk transference, they might rely on 3rd party security firms instead of internal research teams. This would slow down discovery and leave more time for attackers to exploit vulnerabilities. If they used risk avoidance, they would stop developing more complex software, which is very unrealistic and would collapse their business.

Case C: JP Morgan Chase

Vulnerability: lots of data also reactive

The 2014 Breach exposed weakness in their cybersecurity posture and showed that their defenses were very weak and not strong enough to protect the sensitive financial data they had access to. Strategies to fix it would be increasing the budget to allow for better tools to be used. Even doubling the cybersecurity workforce improved monitoring and response, and advanced technologies like ai help that helps detect threats faster and more efficiently. This situation would be reactive because JP Morgan Chase only made major changes after the breaches happened not to fix it from happening. They did it from a past experience, they don't want to be liable. If they chose a different strategy if they used risk acceptance, they would continue operating with weak defenses, leading to repeated breaches and massive financial losses. If they used risk avoidance , they would reduce online services. Which would make them fall behind all other competitors.